Professional Bodies in Computing

CS4001-Professional Practices

Course Instructor: Engr. Sania Urooj

DEVELOPMENT OF PROFESSIONAL BODIES IN COMPUTING

A professional body usually starts by a group of people coming together because of a shared interest in a particular type of activity.

There are many professional bodies and they cover a very wide range of professions, including:

- the law, medicine,
- many different branches of science and engineering, accountancy, architecture, surveying, and many others.

The British Computer Society (BCS) was set up in 1957 by a group of people working in the new and expanding field of computers, who wanted the opportunity to exchange ideas BCS has about 70,000 members.

DEVELOPMENT OF PROFESSIONAL BODIES IN COMPUTING.....

While the role of professional bodies in the United States is somewhat different from their role in the UK, there are two professional computing bodies based in the USA whose importance is worldwide and immense.

The Institute of Electrical and Electronic Engineers (IEEE) is a professional engineering society based in the USA but with members and activities spread worldwide.

Under the banner of the IEEE first professional society in the field of computing was founded in 1946.

The BCS Royal Charter

A BCS Royal Charter is a formal document, signed by the Queen in 1984, which establishes the organization and lays down its purpose and rules of operation.

The charter of the BCS sets out very clearly the purposes of the institution.

To promote the study and practice of Computing

To advance knowledge and education therein for the benefit of the public.

The BCS Royal Charter.....

The most important rules of (BCS) can be summarized as follows:

1. Establishing a code of conduct to regulate the way members of the body behave in their professional lives and a disciplinary procedure to discipline members who breach this code;
2. Promoting education in the field of Computing;
3. Setting standards of education and experience that must be met by people wishing to become members of the body.

The BCS Royal Charter……

4. Establishing mechanisms for disseminating knowledge of good practice and new developments to its members, through publications & conferences and also increasingly using the Internet;

5. To promote and support standards and codes of practice;

6. To advise government & regulatory bodies about matters within its area of expertise.

Professional Conduct.....

The Code is divided into following sections:

1. The Public Interest
2. Professional Competence and Integrity
3. Duty to the Relevant Authority
4. Duty to the Profession

The highlighted text of the code is as follows:

The Public Interest

You shall:

a) have due regard for public health, privacy, security and wellbeing of others and the environment.

b) have due respect for the legitimate rights of Third Parties.

c) conduct your professional activities without discrimination on the grounds of gender, marital status, nationality, color, race, ethnic origin, religion, age or disability, or of any other condition or requirement

d) promote equal access to the benefits of IT and seek to promote the inclusion/addition of all sectors in society wherever opportunities arise.

Professional Competence and Integrity

You shall:

a) Only undertake to do work, or provide a service that is within your professional competence.

b) NOT claim any level of competence that you do not possess.

c) Develop your professional knowledge, skills and competence on a continuing basis, maintaining awareness of technological developments, procedures, and standards that are relevant to your field.

Professional Competence and Integrity.....

d) Ensure that you have the knowledge & understanding of Legislation & that you comply with such Legislation in carrying out your professional responsibilities.

e) Respect and value alternative viewpoints and, seek, accept and offer honest criticisms of work.

f) Avoid injuring others, their property, reputation, or employment by false or malicious or negligent action or inaction.

g) Reject and will not make any offer of bribery or unethical inducement.

Duty to the Relevant Authority

You shall

a) Carry out your professional responsibilities with due care and diligence in accordance with the Relevant Authority's requirements whilst exercising your professional judgment at all times.

b) Seek to avoid any situation that may give rise to a conflict of interest between you and your Relevant Authority.

c) Accept professional responsibility for your work and for the work of colleagues who are defined in a given context as working under your supervision.

Duty to the Relevant Authority….

d) NOT disclose or authorize to be disclosed, or use for personal gain or to benefit a third party, confidential information except with the permission of your Relevant Authority, or as required by Legislation.

e) NOT misrepresent or withhold information on the performance of products, systems or services (unless lawfully bound by a duty of confidentiality not to disclose such information), or take advantage of the lack of relevant knowledge or inexperience of others.

Duty to the Profession

You shall:

a) Accept your personal duty to maintain the reputation of the profession and not take any action, which could bring the profession into disrepute.

b) Seek to improve professional standards through participation in their development, use and enforcement.

c) Uphold the reputation and good standing of BCS, the Chartered Institute for IT.

Duty to the Profession……

d) *Act with integrity and respect in your professional relationships with all members of BCS and with members of other professions with whom you work in a professional capacity.*

e) *Notify BCS if convicted of a criminal offence or upon becoming bankrupt or disqualified as a Company Director and in each case give details of the relevant jurisdiction.*

f) *Encourage and support fellow members in their professional development.*